

Big A – 打大A

A 5-player climbing game with a hidden or revealed partner, solo overcalls, bombs, and set-capturing 4s

Setup

Setup: Play with 5 players and 108 cards: two 54-card decks with red and black Jokers. Deal and play are anticlockwise. Players draw cards one by one, keeping only their final drawn card face down until the Big A is fixed. The first 3 players draw 22 cards; the other 2 draw 21.

At any time during the draw, a player may expose an **Ace**, making that suit **Big A**. That player becomes **declarer**. The holder of the **identical Ace** from the other deck is their **partner**, but remains hidden unless revealed.

A player may **overcall** by exposing **both identical Aces** of one suit; those become the new Big Aces and that player now plays **solo**. Likewise, a declarer who later gets the second identical Big Ace may expose it to confirm **solo play** and prevent overcalls.

If nobody exposed an Ace during the draw, players are asked in draw order whether they hold an **Ace of hearts**. The first player who does must expose it and becomes declarer. Then everyone picks up their final face-down card. In this forced-heart case, the partner **cannot reveal** to increase the stakes.

If the forced declarer then turns out to hold **both** heart Aces, they may **surrender** instead of playing solo against four: declarer -4 , each opponent $+1$.

After Big A is fixed, everyone picks up their final card. If this was **not** a forced-heart declaration, the matching Big Ace holder may now reveal as **partner** (or as a **solo declarer**); this **doubles the total stakes**. If the partner revealed, the **partner leads**; otherwise the **declarer leads**.

Goal & Turn Flow

Objective: Go out first if possible, but avoid being last. First place only scores if your side also avoids last place, while many middle finishes are draws.

A lead may be any legal single or combination. On your turn, either **pass** or play a combination that **beats the current play**. Four consecutive passes clear the pile, and the **last player who played** leads again.

Passing does **not** lock you out of later play. Players who run out of cards drop out and are skipped. The hand ends when all players who still hold cards are known to be on the **same team**.

Endgame lead rule: If no one beats a player's final card or combination, that player drops out and the lead passes anticlockwise to the next active player, skipping known opponents. If the declarer goes out, a revealed partner inherits the lead. Otherwise the same rule applies.

Ordinary Plays

Play	Requirement / Comparison
Single	1 card. Rank: Big A > Red Joker > Black Joker > 3 > 2 > A > K > Q > J > 10 > 9 > 8 > 7 > 6 > 5 > 4 .
Pair	2 equal ranks. Rank: 33 highest down to 44 . Two Big Aces or two Jokers are bombs , not ordinary pairs. A Big Ace + another Ace is just a normal pair of Aces.
Sequence	3+ consecutive singles, same length required. Order is A-K-Q-J-10-9-8-7-6-5-4-3-2-A ; A may be high or low. Jokers are not allowed; Big A counts as an ordinary Ace.
Double sequence	3+ consecutive pairs, same sequence order as above; same length required. Jokers are not allowed.

Bombs

Bombs beat lower bombs and, subject to the notes below, beat ordinary plays. Listed here **from weakest to strongest**:

Bomb	Notes
3 of a kind	Egg .
4 / 5 / 6 of a kind	Big Eggs . Strength: $4 < 5 < 6$ of a kind.
2 Jokers	Any 2 Jokers. Two red Jokers beat two black Jokers .
Triplet sequence	Exactly 3 consecutive triplets , e.g. 444-555-666.
Fake Eight	2 consecutive 4-of-a-kinds , e.g. 4444-5555.
7 / 8 of a kind	Strength: $7 < 8$ of a kind.
3 Jokers	
4 Jokers	
Big A pair	Both Big Aces; only possible in solo play .

Same-type set bombs compare by repeated card rank: **3 high, 4 low**. Triplet sequences and Fake Eights compare like sequences.

Important exceptions

- An Egg does **not** beat a Joker, a lone Big A, or a double sequence.
- 4 of a kind** does **not** beat a lone Big A.

Sets of 4s

A set of **two or more 4s** may be played to **capture** an **Egg** or **Big Egg** with **exactly one more card**: **44** captures a 3-of-a-kind, **444** captures a 4-of-a-kind, **4444** captures a 5-of-a-kind, and **44444** captures a 6-of-a-kind.

The captured bomb is added to the capturer's hand, and the played 4s stay on the pile as an ordinary **pair** / **triplet** / **etc.**; play continues from there.

Notes: sets of 4s may also be played **normally**; a set of **three or more 4s** can itself be captured by a smaller set of 4s; 4s **cannot** capture your own earlier bomb, joker bombs, or sets larger than 6 cards. Capturing Big Aces **never changes the teams**.

Scoring

If the partner **did not reveal** before play:

Big A team result	Declarer	Partner	Each opponent
1st & 2nd	+6	+3	-3
1st & 3rd	+4	+2	-2
1st & 4th	+2	+1	-1
1st & 5th	0	0	0
2nd & 3rd	0	0	0
2nd & 4th	0	0	0
Declarer 2nd, Partner 5th	-2	-1	+1
Partner 2nd, Declarer 5th	-4	-2	+2
3rd & 4th	0	0	0
Declarer 3rd, Partner 5th	-2	-1	+1
Partner 3rd, Declarer 5th	-4	-2	+2
4th & 5th	-6	-3	+3

If the partner **revealed** before play, the total swing is doubled and shared **equally** by the Big A team:

Big A team result	Declarer	Partner	Each opponent
1st & 2nd	+9	+9	-6
1st & 3rd	+6	+6	-4
1st & 4th	+3	+3	-2
1st & 5th	0	0	0
2nd & 3rd	0	0	0
2nd & 4th	0	0	0
Declarer 2nd, Partner 5th	-3	-3	+2
Partner 2nd, Declarer 5th	-6	-6	+4
3rd & 4th	0	0	0
Declarer 3rd, Partner 5th	-3	-3	+2
Partner 3rd, Declarer 5th	-6	-6	+4
4th & 5th	-9	-9	+6

If the declarer holds **both Big Aces** and plays **solo**:

Declarer's result	Declarer	Each opponent
1st, both exposed	+64	-16
1st, only one exposed	+32	-8
2nd / 3rd / 4th	0	0
5th, both exposed	-64	+16
5th, only one exposed	-32	+8
Forced-heart surrender	-4	+1

QQ Game Yuanbao variant: The usual draw-type results score instead of 0.

Big A team result	Declarer	Partner	Each opponent
1st & 5th	+2	+1	-1
2nd & 3rd	+2	+1	-1
2nd & 4th	-2	-1	+1
3rd & 4th	-2	-1	+1

If the partner **revealed** before play, the total swing is doubled and shared **equally** by the Big A team:

Big A team result	Declarer	Partner	Each opponent
1st & 5th	+3	+3	-2
2nd & 3rd	+3	+3	-2
2nd & 4th	-3	-3	+2
3rd & 4th	-3	-3	+2

For **solo play**, these middle finishes score differently:

Declarer's result	Declarer	Each opponent
2nd	+16	-4
4th	-16	+4